A Novel Educational Tool for Teaching Diagnostic Reasoning and Laboratory Data Interpretation to Veterinary (and Medical) Students

Holly S. Bender, DVM, PhD*, Jared A. Danielson, PhD

KEYWORDS

• Clinical pathology • Case based learning • Problem solving • Diagnostic reasoning • Expert thinking • Cognitive tool • Learning • Software design and development

Readers of *Clinics in Laboratory Medicine* no doubt share an interest in laboratory science and clinical pathology, but it is likely that few dreamed of becoming laboratorians while growing up. More often, interest in clinical pathology is piqued by particular courses or instructors or when we discover the compelling power of laboratory data to uncover and clarify hidden disease. Experienced diagnosticians, veterinarians, and physicians, with expertise developed over years of diligent study and practice, become increasingly adept at learning to trace back through a cascade of data abnormalities, using logic to connect them to underlying mechanisms of disease and ultimately identifying failing organ systems. They also learn to value data that assure of healthy organ

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Department of Veterinary Pathology, College of Veterinary Medicine, Iowa State University, 1600 South 16th Street, Ames, IA 50011, USA
* Corresponding author.
E-mail address: hbender@iastate.edu

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